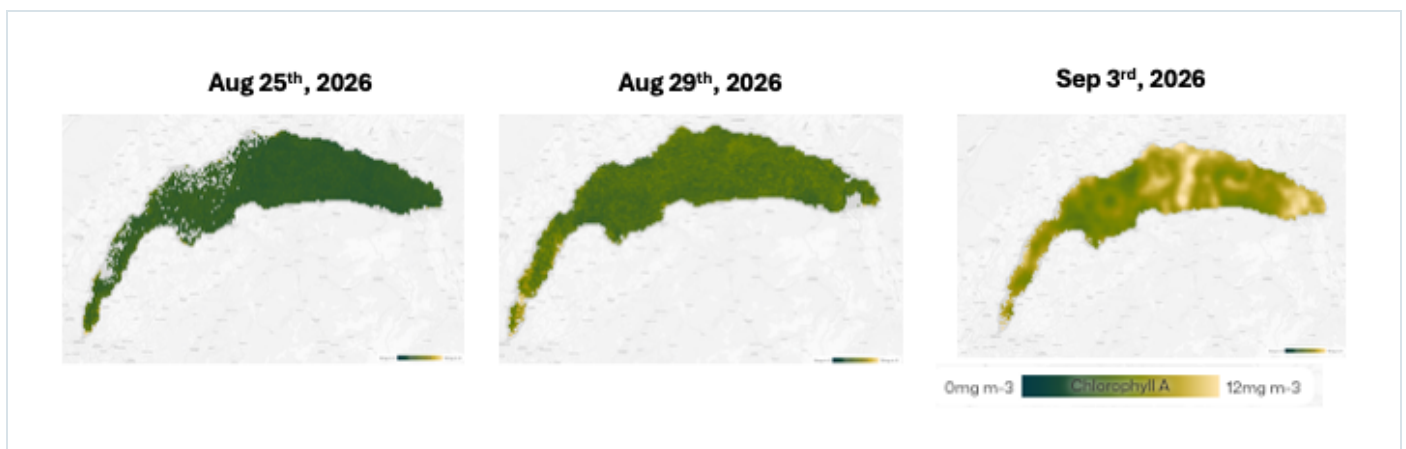


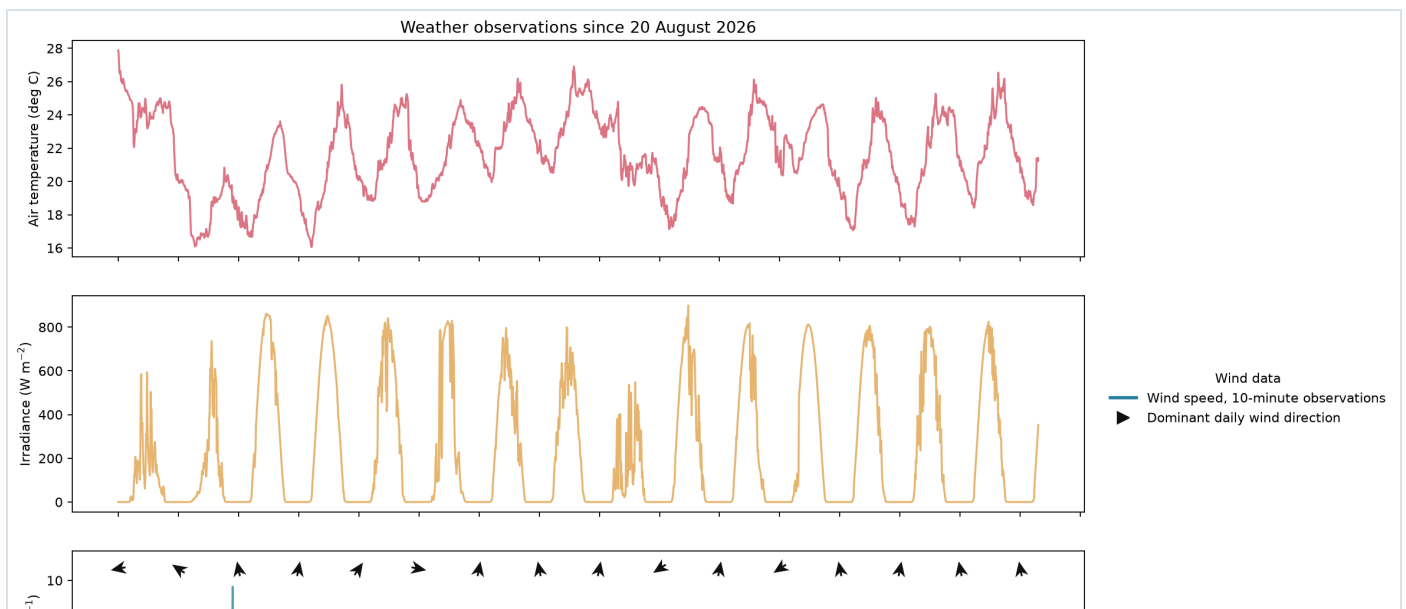
Why has Lake Geneva suddenly turned green?

You may have noticed that the lake's water turned turbid and green in a matter of days. Satellite images confirmed that while low in August 25th, the amount of algae has doubled as of today.

What happened and is this unusual?



Satellite chlorophyll-a observations, August–September 2026 Source asset: AlpLakes

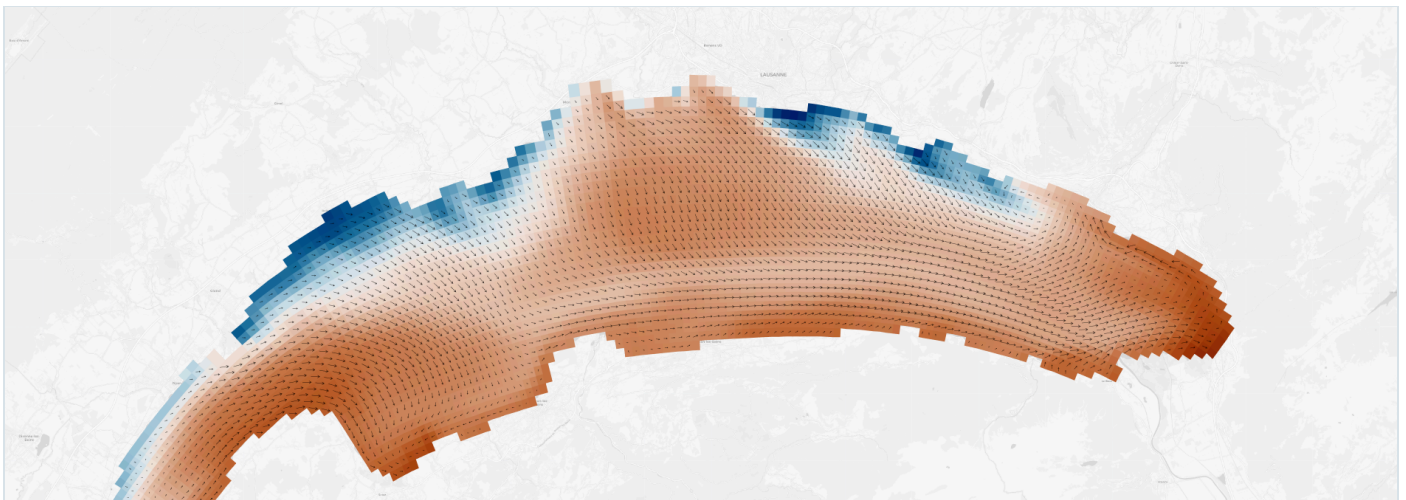


Heat, mixing, and the water column

The temperature 3D model and CTD profiles provide the vertical context behind the surface signal.

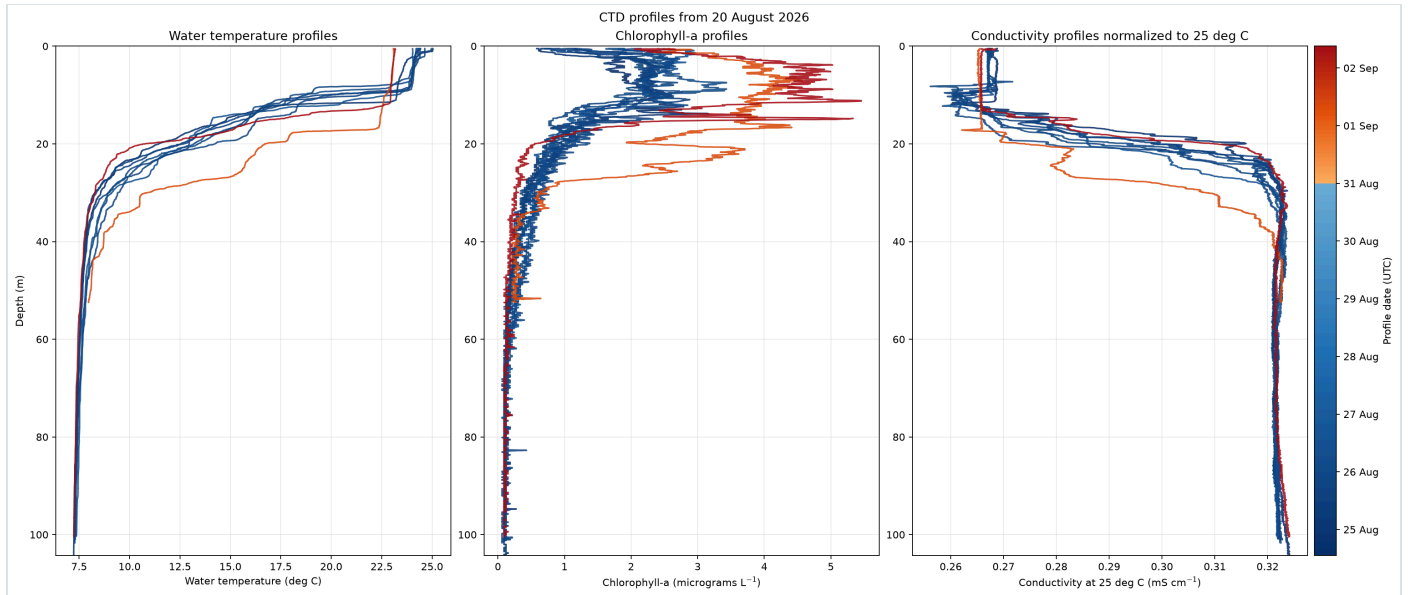


Surface water temperatures from 28 August to 3 September 2026. Source asset: AlpLakes



What the water column reveals

The CTD profiles show how temperature, chlorophyll-a, and conductivity vary with depth during the event.



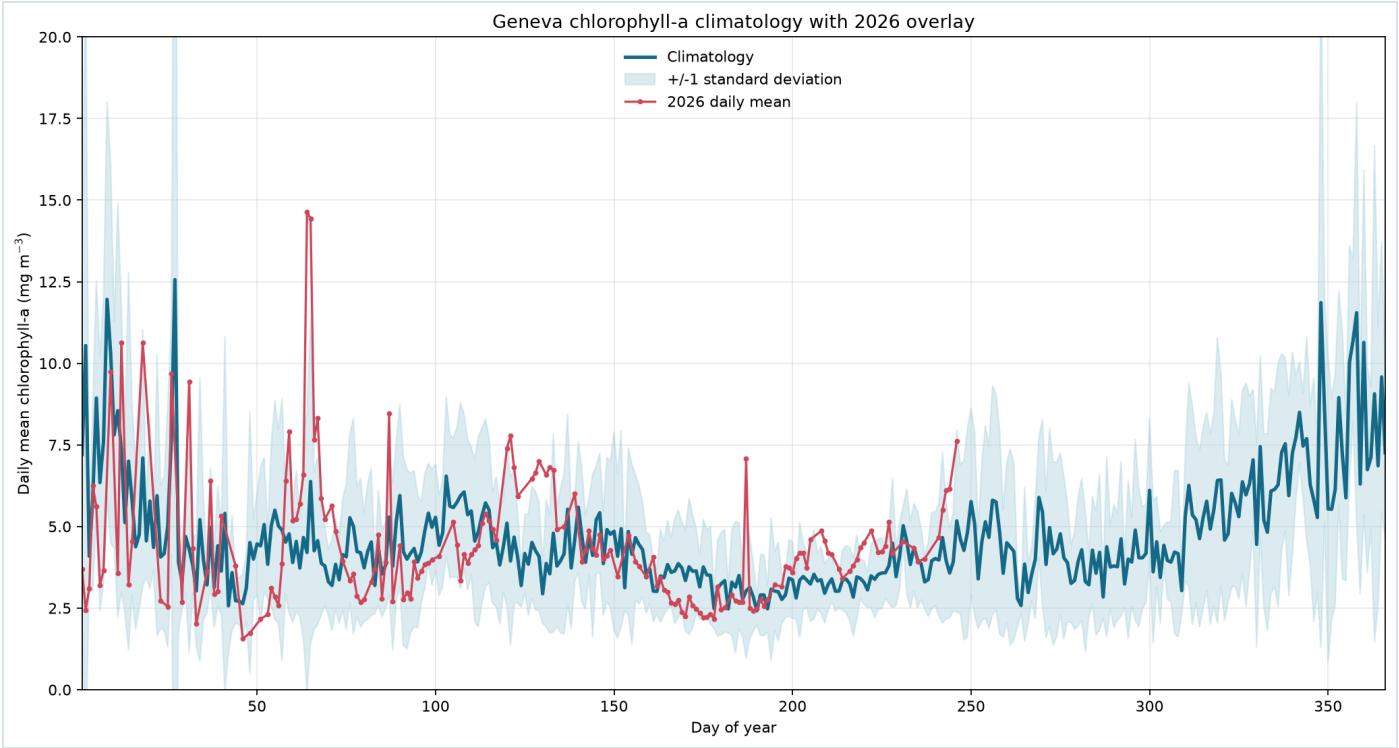
CTD depth profiles after 20 August 2026: water temperature, chlorophyll-a, and conductivity normalized to 25 °C. Profiles are colored by date.

Commentary

The wind event led to tilting and deepening of the thermocline and brought up to the surface colder waters. Deep cold waters are rich in nutrients, such as phosphorous... While the surface waters were limited in nutrients, a fresh supply in phosphorous and sunny conditions makes the surface waters ground for algal growth

Is this unusual?

The bloom is sudden but the climatology of remote-sensed chlorophyll for the lake over the last 11 years shows that this regain in algal growth is rather typical for late summer. The satellite record places the 2026 chlorophyll-a observations within the seasonal distribution and the year-to-year spread.



Geneva chlorophyll-a day-of-year climatology with 2026 observations overlaid. The analysis uses the satellite mean chlorophyll-a field.

